

Patrick Vieira

Lead Platform Engineer · London

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PROFILE

I lead platform engineering at a small London fintech, reporting to the CEO. I joined in 2023 to run IT and operations, grew the role into platform engineering, and now own architecture, infrastructure, identity and security, and carry production. I build the developer platform the team ships with and hold AI-written code to the same standard as anyone's: a written spec first, tests first, gated by CI and reviewed by a model from a second vendor.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Platform Engineer, Altimist Ltd

Aug 2023 – present

- Founded and run the internal developer platform for AI-assisted delivery, built around a golden path from spec to merge: a Claude Code plugin and an engineering-standards baseline rolled out to about 26 repositories by automated pull request, with new repositories brought under golden-path governance as code. Specs before code, tests first, a gate that stops an agent finishing until typecheck, lint and tests pass, and adversarial review by a second vendor's model, which is also how I review the team's work. Three colleagues now extend it (40+ of their pull requests merged since July 2026).
- Scaffolded the company's AI assistant product (Next.js on Cloudflare Workers) and am one of its four engineers, with 400+ merged pull requests since August 2026: age verification, WhatsApp and iMessage channels, safety-escalation paging, and the security baseline (headers, secret and dependency scanning in CI).
- Wrote the product's release pack: a timed database restore drill (recovered in 2 min 15 s with no data lost), a rehearsed production rollback and de-duplicated on-call alerting. Diagnosed a public-site outage caused by an origin certificate that could not renew, and moved the domain to edge-served routing so it cannot recur.
- Built the first version of the company's identity provider: WebAuthn passkeys on did:web with W3C Verifiable Credentials, the sign-in for internal applications since May 2026, with client libraries published on npm. Handed it over to a colleague in August 2026.
- Run cloud and SaaS infrastructure as code through Terraform Cloud (plan on pull request, apply on merge, daily drift detection) across GitHub, Cloudflare, Kafka, Databricks and observability. Moved all hosting to Cloudflare Workers and retired Vercel (Sep 2026); removing Vercel's per-seat charges cut the monthly hosting bill roughly tenfold.
- Put Microsoft 365 and access security under code: phishing-resistant MFA for admins, a geo-fenced sign-in policy piloted in report-only mode before enforcement, a scheduled quarterly compliance evidence pack, and leaver tooling that suspends access in every system and verifies nothing survives. Moved AWS from root-account use to IAM Identity Center.
- Built an on-premises Python speech pipeline on an NVIDIA DGX Spark (NeMo transcription, diarisation, voiceprint speaker naming) for audio that cannot leave the building; it feeds searchable, human-verified records for decision and action tracking.
- Building the Software Factory, an agent execution and evaluation platform with the same golden path as its backbone: sandboxed runs with per-run credentials, durable queue-driven dispatch, review stations against written criteria and an automatic revert watcher. Running in staging; no production runs yet.
- Set technical direction through architecture decision records (44 of the company's 61) and wrote the onboarding guides and handovers colleagues work from. 1,400+ merged pull requests across 40 repositories in ten months, including agent-assisted work.

Software development and retraining, Self-employed

Sep 2021 – Aug 2023

- Built Altimist's first website and launch waitlist on the Internet Computer in Motoko, which led to joining the company. Delivered a paid client website while retraining in full-stack development (JavaScript, React, Python, REST APIs, SQL). Tutored A-Level and IB mathematics privately.

- Taught mathematics across Key Stages 3–5, including GCSE and A-Level, adapting lessons to gaps in pupils' understanding. Completed the NQT induction year and a further year.

Earlier: academic tutor and mentor, Leading Lights Tuition (2015–2018); special projects coordinator and volunteer corps member, City Year UK (2014–2016).

SELECTED PERSONAL PROJECTS

- **patrickjv.com**: One content file generates the page, schema.org data, llms.txt, Markdown and WebMCP tools, plus a remote MCP server listed on the MCP Registry; Cloudflare Workers, 110+ tests and a production smoke monitor.
- **Writing (patrickjv.com/writing)**: Holding agent-written code to the same standard as anyone's; Rehearse the restore, time the rollback.
- **Marine forecast service**: A Python service, running unattended since February 2026, that emails twice-daily ensemble forecasts to a yacht at sea, with database migrations, a watchdog and delivery tracking.

SKILLS

Programming	TypeScript, Python, SQL, PowerShell
Platform and delivery	internal developer platforms, golden paths, developer experience, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), GitOps, infrastructure as code, test-driven development, code review, release and rollback practice, architecture decision records
AI	agentic AI, AI agents, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), LLM evaluation (review gates), speech recognition (NVIDIA NeMo)
Infrastructure	Cloudflare (Workers, Containers, Queues, Durable Objects, R2), Terraform Cloud, Neon Postgres, AWS (organisation and IAM), Microsoft 365 and Entra ID
Identity and security	WebAuthn passkeys, did:web, Verifiable Credentials, conditional access, identity and access management, secrets management (1Password)

EDUCATION

PGCE Secondary Mathematics, University College London (IOE)	2018 – 2019
BEng (Hons) Electrical and Electronic Engineering, 2:1, University of East London	2011 – 2014

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

English (native), Portuguese (fluent), Cantonese (intermediate)